

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner driving mobile app strategy at scale.*

Positioning, seasoned Product Owner with ten years of cross-functional delivery experience, ready to own the congstar app backlog end-to-end.

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§ WHY CONGSTAR

congstar operates one of Germany's most-used MVNO apps with a user base that spans every demographic, which means the PO role carries real commercial weight, not just feature coordination. The job description is explicit about wanting someone who can hold the line between user needs, business goals, and technical constraints simultaneously – that three-way balancing act is exactly where I have spent the last several years. The signal that landed: you are looking for someone who moves in a "lernorientiertes Team, das Verantwortung übernimmt, offen diskutiert" – which describes how I prefer to operate, not a culture I would need to adapt to. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication and spec review
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-sprint implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, lightweight in-repo work
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentation decks
- **n8n**, workflow and agent automation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, JavaScript, AngularJS, Ionic, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, GitOps pipelines, Bitbucket, MicroStrategy, low-code insurance platform, CGM API integration, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & TRADING BOT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp)

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Crypto market analytics and algorithmic execution tooling, built and maintained as a personal infrastructure project.

- Implements backtesting logic for perpetual and spot strategies across centralised and decentralised venues.
 - Designed around a modular, file-queue-based agent loop with clean separation of data ingestion, signal generation, and execution.
 - Integrates market-structure data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital alongside exchange APIs.
 - Demonstrates hands-on comfort with the same kind of async, event-driven backend architecture that underpins a high-traffic consumer app.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CONGSTAR

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I join the cross-functional team, shadow sprint ceremonies, read the existing backlog top-to-bottom, and map the current iOS and Android release cadence against the open stakeholder asks to locate the biggest prioritisation blind spots.

WEEK 2

Sharpen, slice, align.

I propose a first round of backlog refinement – rewriting vague items as testable user stories with clear acceptance criteria – and align on definition-of-ready with the developers and IT analysts.

WEEK 3 +

Ship, close, repeat.

I take ownership of sprint planning, drive the first release increment I can fully vouch for end-to-end, and establish a lightweight rhythm of stakeholder updates that keeps all parties informed without adding ceremony overhead.

I COVER LETTER

Sehr geehrtes congstar-Team,

congstar holds a genuinely unusual position in the German mobile market: a brand that competes on simplicity and price while running on Deutsche Telekom's network infrastructure. That combination creates a product challenge that interests me – the app has to feel independent and approachable while the backend complexity of a full MVNO sits just beneath the surface. I have spent the last several years working in environments with exactly that kind of tension between visible simplicity and invisible complexity.

At Emil Group I inherited a B2B InsurTech platform where delivery had stalled, a 17-person scrum team was producing noise rather than output, and client trust was eroding. I split the team, reintroduced sprint discipline, rebuilt the backlog from scratch, and ran weekly product workshops until the client started looking forward to them rather than dreading them. The Claims Center module went from concept to production during that period. That experience taught me that backlog health is a cultural problem as much as a process one, and that a PO's most important job is often to create enough clarity that engineers can make good decisions independently.

At CLINET Platforms I owned a mobile-first hospital app across iOS and Android – the closest direct parallel to this role. The constraint environment there was severe: legacy CGM APIs, external hospital information systems, strict clinical workflows, and a small team with no slack. I made hard prioritisation calls daily, communicated technical blockers transparently to non-technical hospital stakeholders, and shipped core patient-facing flows on time. The discipline of working mobile-first, where screen real estate is scarce and every tap counts, shaped how I think about product decisions.

At Rohde & Schwarz I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end on a defence-grade AI data platform – writing user stories, supporting implementation, running acceptance testing, and managing GitOps-based rollout myself when the team was bottlenecked. That kind of hands-on fluency is not because I want to be an engineer; it is because I have found that a PO who can read a PR, understand a deployment pipeline, and unblock an infrastructure issue independently earns a different kind of trust from development teams than one who cannot.

I am based in Berlin, hold German citizenship, and am available within four weeks of an offer. I would be glad to talk through how my experience maps to where the congstar app is heading.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience owning mobile and web product backlogs in agile, cross-functional teams. Proven track record of restoring sprint discipline, aligning stakeholder expectations, and shipping customer-facing features in regulated and technically complex environments. Direct experience leading iOS and Android app delivery. Fluent in the technical context of mobile backends, REST integrations, and Kubernetes-based deployments – able to read the technical landscape without needing to write the code. Operates with low ego, high agency, and a clear bias toward decisions that produce value for end users.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Mobile app product ownership across iOS and Android
- Backlog structuring, prioritisation, and sprint discipline
- Cross-functional alignment across engineering, QA, and business stakeholders
- Technical fluency in REST APIs, mobile backends, and deployment pipelines
- Client and stakeholder trust-building under delivery pressure
- Requirements engineering: translating workflows into dev-ready user stories
- Product discovery and risk-first prioritisation under ambiguity
- AI-native tooling for rapid prototyping and spec acceleration
- Founder-level pragmatism, full ownership, low ceremony overhead

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Owned the full product backlog for a mobile-first iOS and Android hospital pilot app, making daily prioritisation calls under tight deadlines.
- Delivered core patient-facing flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage.
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows, navigating legacy API constraints and external database dependencies.
- Built transparent stakeholder communication practices that maintained trust with clinical and technical counterparts throughout delivery.

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Restored sprint discipline on a stalled B2B platform by splitting a bloated 17-person team into smaller, accountable Scrum units with clear ownership.
- Designed and shipped a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout.
- Re-established velocity tracking and structured refinement practices; reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure.
- Regained client trust through structured communication and weekly product workshops in a prototype-stage environment.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform: labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling.
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades with minimal service disruption.
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage.
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time.

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Led cross-functional delivery of a central AI and data management platform within the European defence programme FCAS.

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout.
 - Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD.
 - Independently unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year.
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware.
- Designed for a setup time under two minutes with no technical knowledge required from end users.
- Served concurrently as deputy IT security officer.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded and built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and a mobile app prototype.
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Managed migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policy workflows.
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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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